

029. Chapter 3 Verses 7-8

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.7

यस्त्विन्द्रियाणि मनसा नियम्यारभतेऽर्जुन ।
कर्मेन्द्रियैः कर्मयोगमसक्तः स विशिष्यते ॥ ७ ॥

yas tvindriyāṇi manasā niyamyārabhate 'rjuna
karmendriyaiḥ karma-yogam asaktaḥ sa viśiṣhyate

yaḥ—who; tu—but; indriyāṇi—the senses; manasā—by the mind; niyamyā—control; ārabhate—begins; arjuna—Arjun; karma-indriyaiḥ—by the working senses; karma-yogam—karm yog; asaktaḥ—without attachment; saḥ—they; viśiṣhyate—are superior

But, O Arjuna! he who controls the senses with the mind, and commences the discipline of Karma yoga by his organs of action without attachment, is the best.

VERSE 3.8

नियतं कुरु कर्म त्वं कर्म ज्यायो ह्यकर्मणः ।
शरीरयात्रापि च ते न प्रसिद्ध्येदकर्मणः ॥ ८ ॥

niyatam kuru karma tvam karma jyāyo hyakarmaṇaḥ
śharīra-yātrāpi cha te na prasiddhyed akarmaṇaḥ

niyatam—constantly; **kuru**—perform; **karma**—Vedic duties; **tvam**—you; **karma**—action; **jyāyaḥ**—superior; **hi**—certainly; **akarmaṇaḥ**—than inaction; **śharīra**—bodily; **yātrā**—maintenance; **api**—even; **cha**—and; **te**—your; **na prasiddhyet**—would not be possible; **akarmaṇaḥ**—inaction

Doing the work prescribed by the Sastras is superior to inaction. By inaction, even maintenance of the body for you would not be possible